

Sympoiesis, composed of two Greek roots, “*sún*” meaning together and “*poíesis*”, denoting creation, encompasses the ability for a dynamic system to self organize. The word can be translated as the phenomenon of making with. It can be compared to a polyrhythmic structure in which each rhythm's complexity becomes entangled with one another in harmony. Sympoietic systems are characterized by spontaneity; they are *organizationally ajar*¹³ and host a platform open to encounters. In working together we partake in the process of sympoiesis; exchange helps us learn and flourish as an ensemble.

A soft suggestion for sympoietic scores

inspired by collaborations with nature

Intrinsic qualities

at times forgotten or asleep
are needed to tune-in
for a successful *cookout*

centering and deep listening
art of dialogue
embodying intention and action

Ingredients:

two or more enthusiastic earthlings
a space to interact
matter to transform

Invocation:

a song for working-with to be sung together

Begin to make a rhythm with your body or an improvised instrument
Select a line to sing (some lines can be sung together)

finding multiple polyrhythmic layers
of collective consciousness
rumbling worldly
synergetics
and consent
aggregates of fragments
lucid eagerness to understand

hosts of soft landings
merging in melodies
eternally regenerating
synchronization
with otherness
learning and unlearning
epiphanies of entangled play



Activation:

- Commence with each participant selecting an ingredient from what is in proximity, whether it be in the fridge, pantry, garden, or market. Select your ingredient in response to something that sparks a memory of interaction; something that was eaten with someone, or learned to cook from somewhere.
- Next ingredient(s) you choose should be ones you are not familiar with, perhaps something you have never 'seen' or considered. Bring it to the 'table' and ask other participants about their experience with this edible element(s).
- Form small groups and assemble one dish from the selected ingredients of each person, bringing both the familiar and the unfamiliar into play.
- Discuss the origins of the selected ingredients, their morphosis and trajectories. How did they begin; by seed, by liquid, by powder? What types of transformations did they undertake to arrive in front of you? What elements were they contingent upon for their development? What other species did they exist alongside with?
- Now invite a new encounter for the next round of ingredients — the spontaneous collaborator. Select an ingredient that feels out of context and consider how to integrate it with the other elements of the dish. How do you welcome the spontaneous collaborator?
- Bring all ingredients into a new dimension of interaction, allowing them to communicate. Be brave in creating new forms and uncanny flavors.
- Imagine the recipe as a collectively constructed poem, with each series of ingredients as a stance. What tale does this recipe tell? Make note of these stories to share around the dining table.



